Comparison: Conversational Test vs. General Intelligence

A conversational test, such as the Turing Test proposed by Alan Turing in 1950, evaluates whether a machine can communicate in a way that appears similar to a human. However, passing this test does not prove general intelligence because fluent conversation does not necessarily demonstrate reliable reasoning, factual accuracy, learning ability, or successful performance on different tasks.

Scholarship case study: Consider an AI assistant reviewing a scholarship application. The application has a score of 91, but some required documents are missing. The assistant may confidently explain that the applicant should be reviewed because of the high score. Although the explanation sounds convincing, it is incorrect if the documented rule requires all documents to be complete. This example shows that an AI system can produce fluent language while overlooking an important condition.

The conversational test observes the quality of a machine's conversational behavior, but it does not establish that the system understands every situation, follows rules consistently, or makes reliable decisions. General intelligence requires broader evidence of performance across different tasks and situations.

Additional test of reliable task performance: The AI should be tested using a set of scholarship applications with known correct outcomes. The test should include complete applications, missing documents, incorrect scores, and boundary values. Its decisions should be compared with the documented rules, and errors should be recorded. This would provide stronger evidence of reliable task performance than conversational fluency alone.